

Polite Pronouns and the PCC*

Luke James Adamson (ZAS) and Stanislao Zompì (Universität Potsdam)

November 6, 2024

Abstract

The *Person-Case Constraint* (PCC) has played a substantial role in the development of linguistic theory in recent decades, particularly with respect to agreement and the encoding of person (Anagnostopoulou 2017b and references therein). While much of the generative literature on the PCC advances or assumes a (morpho)syntactic agreement-based account of PCC effects, we provide novel evidence from polite pronouns that challenges this perspective. Polite pronouns have the useful property that they exhibit a striking “mismatch” between the features expressed in their agreement and in their forms on the one hand, and what is interpreted on the other. They therefore provide an ideal testing ground for the predictions of morphosyntactic analyses of the PCC, which predict that third-person polite pronouns used for addressees should behave like other third-person arguments and should therefore fail to give rise to PCC effects. We find that this prediction is falsified in Italian for the polite pronoun *LEI*, which is used for formal address but is grammatically third-person, and for which PCC effects obtain; we make related observations for the related person-hierarchy effect connected to the so-called Fancy Constraint (Postal 1989). We suggest that the PCC pattern with polite pronouns is more consistent with a syntacticosemantic, interpretation-based account of the PCC, such as that of Pancheva and Zubizarreta (2018), and sketch how this can be captured in their system. Lastly, we identify cross-linguistic expectations for ditransitives vs. other person-hierarchy effects with polite pronouns, and show how these expectations are borne out for Spanish *USTED* and German *SIE*. This

*We are grateful to Artemis Alexiadou, Elena Anagnostopoulou, Karlos Arregi, Nina Haslinger, Giovanni Roversi, Andrés Saab, and audiences at ZAS, Universität Potsdam, and NELS 55 for insightful discussion. Grammaticality judgments for Italian come from several native speaker consultants from different areas of Italy, including one of the authors, Enrico Flor, and Jacopo Romoli. In addition to Leipzig Glossing Rules conventions, we also use IMPRS = impersonal. Note that, unless otherwise stated, finite verbs appear in present indicative forms.

study has important implications for the analysis of person-hierarchy effects and affirms the relevance of polite pronouns to the theory of agreement.

keywords: PCC, person hierarchy, agreement, interpretability

1 Introduction

Many languages exhibit person-based restrictions in their combination of object arguments in ditransitive environments, which have been investigated extensively under the label of Person-Case Constraint (PCC) effects (Bonet 1991, 1994; Anagnostopoulou 2003, 2005, 2017b; Béjar and Rezac 2003; Bianchi 2006; Ormazabal and Romero 2007; Béjar and Rezac 2009; Adger and Harbour 2007; Nevins 2007; Preminger 2009, 2014; Rezac 2011; Pancheva and Zubizarreta 2018; Stegovec 2020; Coon and Keine 2021; Foley and Toosarvandani 2022; Paparounas and Salzmann 2023; Deal 2024; among many others). This type of restriction is found in Italian (e.g. Bianchi 2006; D'Alessandro and Pescarini 2016): while clitic combinations of a 3rd-person indirect object (IO) with a 3rd direct object (DO) (henceforth 3>3) and 2>3 (1-a) are licit, clitic combinations of a 3rd-person IO with a participant DO (such as 2nd) are illicit (1-b)-(1-c).

- (1) a. {Glie= /te} la ha affidat-a.
 3SG.DAT 2SG.DAT 3F.SG.ACC has entrusted-F.SG
 ‘(S)he entrusted her to him/her/you.’
 b. *{Gli(e) /le} {ti /te} ha affidat{-o/-a}.
 3SG.DAT 2SG.ACC have.3SG entrusted-{M.SG/F.SG}
 Intended: ‘She entrusted you to him/her.’
 c. *{Ti /te} {gli(e) /le} ha affidat{-o/-a}.
 2SG.ACC 3SG.DAT have.3SG entrusted-{M.SG/F.SG}
 Intended: ‘She entrusted you to him/her.’ (cf. Bianchi 2006)

PCC effects have played a substantial role in the theory of agreement and the encoding of person (Anagnostopoulou 2017b and references therein). While accounts vary greatly, most in the generative literature converge on the idea that PCC effects arise in the morphosyntax, e.g. via restrictions on Agree with multiple goals (Béjar and Rezac

2003; Anagnostopoulou 2005; Coon and Keine 2021; Deal 2024; among many others).

In the present work, we provide evidence from ‘polite’ pronouns that challenges the received view that PCC effects with ditransitives should be attributed to morphosyntax.¹ Polite pronouns have the useful property that they exhibit a mismatch between the features expressed in their form and in their agreement on the one hand, and what is interpreted on the other. They thus provide an ideal testing ground for morphosyntactic analyses of the PCC, which predict that polite pronouns that are formally 3rd-person but used for addressees should behave like 3rd-person arguments rather than 2nd, thereby failing to give rise to PCC effects. We find that this prediction is falsified in Italian for the polite pronoun *LEI*, which, as we show, is used for formal address but is grammatically 3rd-person, and for which PCC effects obtain (as also briefly noted by D’Alessandro and Pescarini 2016). We further show that *LEI* patterns with 2nd-person arguments for at least one other person-hierarchy effect in Italian, namely Postal’s (1989) ‘Fancy Constraint’, an effect that has also been attributed to morphosyntactic mechanisms responsible for PCC effects (e.g. Sheehan 2020; Deal 2024).

We argue instead that the PCC pattern with *LEI* is more consistent with a syntacticosemantic analysis of the PCC, and we sketch how this can be captured in a system such as that of Pancheva and Zubizarreta 2018. In identifying modularity-based differences between distinct PCC theories, this study has important implications for the theory of person restrictions and provides a novel empirical tool to probe such effects cross-linguistically. While the relevance of polite pronouns to the theory of agreement has been acknowledged in previous studies (see especially Wechsler and Hahm 2011; Ackema and Neeleman 2018), this study is, to our knowledge, novel in situating them within theories of person restrictions.

¹We use the term *morphosyntax* loosely, to encompass both narrow syntax and ‘pure’ morphology, as well as the interface between the two.

The organization of this work is as follows. In Section 2, we lay out the PCC pattern in Italian, which has been observed previously in the literature. In Section 3, we describe the morphosyntactic behavior of the polite pronoun *LEI*, which we demonstrate patterns with third person rather than second person both morphologically and in terms of verbal agreement. In Section 4, we show that PCC effects obtain with *LEI*, extend our observations to another type of person restriction, and contrast *LEI*'s PCC behavior with that of camouflage/imposter nominals. Section 5 then details how morphosyntactic accounts of the PCC are undermined by the data from *LEI*, and sketches one alternative syntacticosemantic account. Section 6 looks at some comparisons with other languages that have also been reported to display person-hierarchy effects and have third-person polite pronouns. Section 7 concludes.

2 The PCC in Italian

As mentioned in Section 1, PCC effects have been reported to obtain in Italian; see especially Bianchi 2006; D'Alessandro and Pescarini 2016 (on other Romance languages, see Perlmutter 1971; Bonet 1991, 1994, among many others). In Italian, object clitics typically precede a finite verb and can occur in clusters that include both the indirect and direct object, as in the combinations in (2) (adapted from Bianchi 2006), repeated from above. In these examples, the indirect object is represented with a dative clitic and the direct object is represented with an accusative clitic, with clitics reflecting person, number, case, and (for third person) gender. As evident from (2), 2>3 and 3>3 clitic combinations are both grammatical.²

²For some clitics, elision of the clitic vowel is possible when a following adjacent verb begins with a vowel, including with the third-person singular feminine *la* and masculine *lo*, though it is not obligatory (see e.g. Maiden and Robustelli 2013:96-97). Because the unelided third-person forms more clearly reflect gender, we opt to include them throughout; to be clear, changing the elision status for our ungrammatical examples does not render them felicitous under the relevant interpretation in any of the cases discussed

- (2) a. Te la ha affidata.
 2SG.DAT 3F.SG.ACC have.3SG entrusted.F.SG
 ‘He entrusted her to you.’
 b. Glie la ha affidata.
 3SG.DAT 3F.SG.ACC have.3SG entrusted.F.SG
 ‘He entrusted her to him/her.’

All (or at least the vast majority of) Italian speakers reject combinations of two argument clitics in which the indirect object is third person and the direct object is first or second person. This is illustrated for second person in (3), ungrammatical regardless of clitic ordering or clitic-allomorph selection.

- (3) *{Gli(e)/le ti /ti gli} ha affidato/affidata.
 3SG.DAT 2SG.ACC 2SG.ACC 3SG.DAT have.3SG entrusted.M.SG/entrusted.F.SG
 ‘He entrusted you to her.’

As is well-known, PCC effects vanish when one of the arguments is a stressed (or ‘tonic’) pronoun rather than a clitic, as observed by Bianchi 2006 for Italian (Bonet 1994 on Catalan, Anagnostopoulou 2003 on Greek, and much subsequent literature). This is shown in (4).

- (4) a. Gli ha affidato te.
 3SG.DAT have.3SG entrusted.M.SG 2SG.STRESS
 ‘He entrusted you to him/her.’
 b. Ti ha affidato a {lui /lei}.
 2SG.ACC have.3SG entrusted.M.SG to 3M.SG.STRESS / 3.F.SG.STRESS
 ‘He entrusted you to him/her.’

While virtually all Italian native speakers reject clitic combinations of 3>1 and 3>2, some speakers also reject combinations of 1>2 and 2>1 (see e.g. Bianchi 2006:2027), as shown in (5).³ Such speakers are said to have a Strong PCC grammar, with speakers who accept these combinations – but not 3>1 or 3>2 – having a Weak PCC grammar. In the

in this manuscript.

³Note that ACC and DAT marking for first and second are syncretic in this environment and the order of the clitics necessarily places first person before second person, regardless of which argument is the IO and which is the DO.

present work, we focus chiefly on 3>2 combinations, though with some discussion of 1>2 combinations in both Sections 4 and 5.⁴

- (5) %Mi ti ha affidato/affidata.
1SG 2SG have.3SG entrusted.M.SG/entrusted.F.SG
%‘She entrusted you to me.’ / %‘She entrusted me to you.’

3 The polite pronoun LEI

The Italian ‘polite’ pronominal series identified here as LEI – in reference to its citation form – is used as a politeness or courtesy form in reference to singular addressees. (For a description of the sociopragmatic conditions under which LEI vs. other forms of address is used, see Maiden and Robustelli 2013:460-465.) In this section, we show that LEI patterns with the third-person feminine singular pronoun in terms of its morphology and in terms of its verbal agreement behavior, including as an object clitic.

LEI is morphologically identical to the third-person feminine singular series, as can be seen in Table 1. As reflected in the table, all of the elements in the LEI series are conventionally capitalized in the written language except for the possessive pronoun, while the third-person feminine forms are not (unless at the beginning of a sentence).

The third-person feminine behavior of LEI is not restricted to identity in pronominal forms. Italian distinguishes second person verbal agreement from third person, as shown in (6). Despite referring to an addressee, LEI triggers third-person agreement (7-a). Note further that, as a *pro*-drop language, Italian allows subjects to be non-overt; LEI may also be dropped, still triggering third-person agreement in politeness contexts (7-b).

⁴We set person-hierarchy effects with reflexives to the side. For discussion of such effects in Italian, see Bianchi 2006; D’Alessandro and Pescarini 2016.

	NOM	ACC clitic	DAT clitic	stressed	POSS
1 SG	io	mi	mi/me	me	mio
2 SG	tu	ti	ti/te	te	tuo
3 SG.M	lui	lo	gli/glie	lui	suo
3 SG.F	lei	la	le/glie	lei	suo
LEI	Lei	La	Le/Glie	Lei	suo
1 PL	noi	ci	ci/ce	noi	nostro
2 PL	voi	vi	vi/ve	voi	vostro
3 PL.M	loro	li	%loro/%gli/%glie	loro	loro
3 PL.F	loro	le	%loro/%gli/%glie	loro	loro

Table 1: Personal Pronominal Series (cf. Maiden and Robustelli 2013:Ch. 6)

- (6) a. Tu {sei /*è} qui.
2SG.NOM be.2SG /be.3SG here
'You are here.'
- b. Lei {è /*sei} qui.
3SG.F.NOM be.3SG /be.2SG here
'She is here.'
- (7) a. Lei {è /*sei} qui.
LEI.NOM be.3SG /be.2SG here
'You (polite) are here.'
- b. Dottor Biagi, *pro* {è /*sei} qui!
Doctor Biagi, PRO be.3SG /be.PRS.2SG here
'Doctor Biagi, you're here!'

Reflexive elements are also distinguished between second and third person: in the second person, reflexive clitics are formally identical to non-reflexive clitics, whereas in the third person, reflexive clitics are realized with *si/se* (8).⁵ In the domain of reflexives, LEI again patterns with the third person (9). (A parallel contrast, omitted here, is found with stressed, non-clitic reflexives.)

- (8) a. {Ti /*si} vedi.
2SG.ACC /3SG.REFL see.2SG
'You see yourself.'
- b. {Si /*ti} vede.
3SG.REFL /2SG.ACC see.3SG
'She sees herself/he sees himself.'
- (9) (Lei) {si /*ti} vede.
LEI.NOM LEI.REFL /2SG.ACC see.3SG
'You see yourself.'

⁵Beyond reflexives, *si/se* is also found in a wider set of environments including impersonals; see D'Alessandro 2007 for an overview and for discussion.

LEI also behaves as a third-person argument and unlike a second-person singular argument for the purposes of clitic-cluster ordering (on the ordering of clitics in Romance, see Pescarini 2021 and references therein). In a combination of an accusative clitic with a locative, the second-person clitic *ti* must precede the locative clitic, as in (10-a), whereas the third person follows the locative, as in (10-b). LEI patterns again with the third person (10-c).

- (10) a. {Ti ci/ *ci ti} hanno portato.
 2SG.ACC LOC LOC 2SG.ACC have.3PL brought.M.SG
 ‘They have brought you there.’
 b. {Ce la/ *la ci} hanno portata.
 LOC 3F.SG.ACC 3F.SG.ACC LOC have.3PL brought.F.SG
 ‘They have brought her there.’
 c. {Ce La/ *La ci} hanno portata.
 LOC LEI.ACC LEI.ACC LOC have.3PL brought.F.SG
 ‘They have brought you (formal) there.’

As an object clitic, LEI is also treated as if it were a third-person feminine argument with respect to participle agreement. In Italian as in many Romance languages, verbal past participles can display agreement with accusative object clitics (see Kayne 1989; Belletti 2017; among many others). Crucially, though, such overt agreement is obligatory with third-person object clitics but optional with participant object clitics (Burzio 1986; Belletti 2017). This is illustrated in the contrast between (11) and (12). In the case of the second person, the form of the clitic (*ti*) does not vary depending on the gender of the referent, whereas agreement on the participle optionally varies: when the clitic refers to a woman, a feminine form can be employed but ‘default’ masculine is also available; when referring to a man, the clitic is necessarily masculine because both the agreeing form and the default are masculine.⁶

⁶The optionality of participial gender agreement with participant clitics might at first seem related to the fact that gender contrasts are not overtly marked on such clitics, thus suggesting an account in terms of gender impoverishment on the clitic optionally bleeding gender agreement with it. However, the phenomenon is in fact more general: for example, participial *number* agreement is also optional with plural participant clitics, despite the number contrast being overtly marked on the clitics themselves in

- (11) a. Maria, *ti* *ho* {*vist-a* /*vist-o*} *ieri* in TV.
 Maria, 2SG.ACC have.1SG seen-M.SG seen-F.SG yesterday in TV
 ‘Maria, I saw you on TV yesterday.’
 b. Pietro, *ti* *ho* {*vist-o* /**vist-a*} *ieri* in TV.
 Pietro, 2SG.ACC have.1SG seen-M.SG seen-F.SG yesterday in TV
 ‘Pietro, I saw you on TV yesterday.’

As shown in (12), LEI as an accusative clitic patterns with third person accusative clitics in that gender agreement is obligatory. Moreover, the agreement is for the formal features of LEI and not for the conceptual gender of the referent, unlike the second person. The gender agreement pattern thus suggests that the clitic LEI behaves as expected if it were a third-person feminine clitic.

- (12) a. La *ho* {*vist-a*/**vist-o*} *ieri* in TV.
 3SG.F.ACC have.1SG seen-F.SG/seen-M.SG yesterday in TV
 ‘I saw her on TV yesterday.’
 b. Lo *ho* {*vist-o*/**vist-a*} *ieri* in TV.
 3SG.M.ACC have.1SG seen-M.SG/seen-F.SG yesterday in TV
 ‘I saw him on TV yesterday.’
- (13) (Dottor Biagi,) La *ho* {*vist-a* /**vist-o*} *ieri* in TV.
 Doctor Biagi, LEI.ACC have.1SG seen-F.SG /seen-M.SG yesterday on TV
 ‘Doctor Biagi, I saw you on TV yesterday.’ (could also mean ‘I saw her on TV
 yesterday.’) (adapted from Maiden and Robustelli 2013:459)

The evidence from the pronominal morphology and the verbal agreement behavior of the polite series indicates that the formal features of LEI are that of the third-person feminine singular.

4 LEI and Person-Hierarchy Effects

In this section, we demonstrate that PCC environments yield ungrammaticality with LEI.

This is significant because approaches that attribute PCC effects to formal agreement

this case (1SG *mi* vs 1PL *ci*, 2SG *ti* vs 2PL *vi*). For syntactic analyses of the pattern, cf. also Guasti and Rizzi 2002:191 and Belletti 2017:499.

rather than to the syntacticosemantic status of arguments predict that third-person polite pronouns should not give rise to PCC effects, because for the purposes of verbal agreement, these pronouns behave as if they were third person, despite being interpreted as referring to addressees. We contextualize this prediction of morphosyntactic accounts more explicitly in Section 5.

We first demonstrate the PCC effect with LEI and third-person clitics and show how it cannot be attributed to a morphological restriction on accusative LEI in clitic clusters (4.1). We extend our observations to another person-hierarchy effect found with LEI in so-called ‘Fancy Constraint’ environments (4.2). Lastly, we contrast LEI with imposters/camouflage DPs, which do not exhibit PCC effects in Italian (4.3).

4.1 LEI *and the PCC*

The example in (14), repeated from (3), displays the PCC effect: the dative clitic is third-person while the accusative clitic is second-person, and the result is ungrammatical.

- (14) *Gli(e)/le ti ha affidato/affidata.
 3SG.DAT 2SG.ACC have.3SG entrusted.M.SG/entrusted.F.SG
 ‘He entrusted you to her.’

We now turn to the interaction between LEI and the PCC. First observe that LEI can appear as the dative clitic with a third-person accusative, as this is not a PCC environment. Like third-person dative clitics (both masculine and feminine), a dative LEI clitic is realized as *glie* in the context of a following clitic; the result is expectedly grammatical (15).

- (15) Glie= la ha affidata.
 {3SG.DAT / LEI.DAT} 3SG.F.ACC have.3SG entrusted.F.SG
 ‘He entrusted her to him/to you (formal).’

Strikingly, when LEI appears as an accusative clitic with a dative third person, the result is ungrammatical (16), displaying a PCC effect comparable to the one observed for

the second-person clitic (14). Note that there is nothing inherently ill-formed about the combination of the third-person dative with a third-person feminine accusative (which is string-identical to (15)).⁷

- (16) *Glie= La ha affidata/affidato.
 3SG.DAT LEI.ACC AUX.3SG entrusted.F.SG
 ‘He entrusted you (formal) to her.’

To ensure that the PCC effect with LEI is genuine, we offered the context in (17) to facilitate the target interpretation. Our consultants still found the relevant clitic combination ungrammatical.

- (17) ‘Oh avvocato, come sta? Non sa quanto mi è dispiaciuto che il mio medico L’abbia trattata male. Quello lì è proprio un cretino sa?’
Oh, esteemed lawyer, how are you (formal)? You don’t know how sorry I was that my doctor treated you badly. He’s a real idiot, isn’t he?
- a. *Io glie-L’ avevo affidata sperando che La
 1SG.NOM 3DAT-LEI.ACC HAD.1SG entrusted.F.SG hoping that LEI.ACC
 curasse perbene (e invece...)
 cure.SUBJ.PST.3SG properly and instead
 ‘I entrusted you to him hoping that he would take care of you properly (and instead...)

While the sentences with (16) and (17) are formed with *affidare* ‘entrust’, we observe the same effect with the verb *raccomandare* ‘recommend’. When LEI is a dative clitic occurring with a third-person accusative, no PCC effect is expected and indeed the sentence is grammatical (18-a). When LEI is an accusative clitic occurring with a third person dative, a PCC effect obtains and the result is ungrammatical (18-b).

- (18) a. Glie= la ha raccomandata.
 LEI.DAT 3F.SG.ACC have.3SG recommended.F.SG
 ‘He recommended her to you.’

⁷The contrast between (15) and (16) also helps assuage the suspicion that the effect might have to do with an excess of markedness in the clitic cluster (on the assumption that DAT-ACC clitic clusters and polite LEI are both inherently marked). If that were the issue, we would expect 3>LEI to be no worse than LEI>3, contrary to fact.

- b. *Glie= La ha raccomandata(/raccomandato).
 3SG.DAT LEI.ACC have.3SG recommended.F.SG
 ‘He recommended you (formal) to her.’

As with PCC effects with the second person, these types of expressions are ‘repaired’ if the ditransitive is not expressed with a combination of two clitics. In (19-a), the dative argument is a clitic while the accusative LEI appears as a stressed postverbal pronoun; the result is well-formed. In (19-b), LEI appears as an accusative clitic with the dative argument appearing postverbally in a prepositional phrase; the result is again grammatical.⁸

- (19) a. Gli ha affidato Lei.
 3SG.DAT have.3SG entrusted.M.SG LEI.STRESS
 ‘(S)he entrusted you to him.’
 b. La ha affidata a lui.
 LEI.ACC have.3SG entrusted.F.SG to 3M.SG
 ‘(S)he entrusted you to him.’

Further confirmation for the PCC effect with LEI comes from corpus results from the Paisà corpus (Lyding et al. 2014). Because of the prescriptive preference to capitalize LEI in the written language, we can ask whether the clitic combination *glie-La* (3SG.DAT-LEI.ACC) is attested in this case-sensitive corpus, and compare it with the non-capitalized *glie-la* (3SG.DAT-3SG.F.ACC). While it is possible that some instances of non-

⁸For completeness, note that PCC effects also hold for expressions in which the pronominal clitics are encliticized to an infinitive. As shown in (i-b), a combination of third-person dative with third-person accusative is licit, as is LEI when it appears as the dative. We observe, however, that LEI as an accusative clitic in this infinitival environment is ungrammatical with a third-person dative clitic (i-c).

- (i) a. *Intendo affidar {gli ti}/ {ti gli}
 intend.1SG entrust.INF 3SG.DAT 2SG.ACC 2SG.ACC 3SG.DAT
 ‘I intend to entrust you to him.’
 b. Intendo affidar {glie= /Glie=} la.
 intend.1SG entrust.INF 3SG.DAT /LEI.DAT 3SG.ACC
 ‘I intend to entrust her to him/you (formal).’
 c. *Intendo affidar glie= La.
 intend.1SG entrust.INF 3SG.DAT LEI.ACC
 ‘I intend to entrust you to him.’

capitalized *gliela* could be instances where the accusative is meant to be interpreted as polite LEI, our expectation is at least that there should be no instances of capitalized LEI in this position. A corpus search in 2024 yielded 580 hits for the string *gliela* tagged as a ‘clitic pronoun’ but zero hits for *glieLa* (even without tags).

The restriction on the distribution of LEI cannot be attributed to an inability for LEI to participate in clitic clusters. LEI is shown above in (15) as a dative argument with a third-person accusative; we also specifically observe that the accusative form *La* can appear with a preceding locative clitic, as in (20-a), or with an impersonal clitic *si* (which follows *La*), as in (20-b).⁹

- (20) a. Dottore, alla fine ce La hanno portata, in tribunale?
 doctor in.the end LOC LEI.ACC have.3PL brought.F.SG in court
 ‘Doctor, did they drag you to court in the end?’
 b. Onorevole, perché La si soprannomina così?
 congressperson, why LEI.ACC IMPRS refer.to.3SG this.way
 ‘Congressperson, how come they call you that?’

Based on the preceding evidence, we conclude that the third-person polite pronoun LEI patterns with second person clitics in inducing PCC effects, rather than with third person. Before proceeding, recall from Section 2 that some Italian speakers accept combinations of first or second person accusative clitics when the dative is also first or sec-

⁹Further evidence that the accusative LEI clitic is morphologically well-formed in clitic clusters comes from ethical dative contexts, which have been observed not to give rise to PCC effects (see Bianchi 2006 on Italian). LEI may appear felicitously as an accusative clitic in an ethical dative context; we find that first-person ethical datives are easiest to judge. Recall that Weak PCC Italian speakers do not accept combinations of participant clitics (see (21-a)). In contrast, all speakers, including Weak PCC speakers, accept a combination of a dative first-person and an accusative second-person clitic in an ethical dative construction, like that seen in (i-a). Perhaps unsurprisingly, LEI in accusative position is well-formed in the ethical dative construction (i-b), including for Weak PCC speakers.

- (i) a. Come mi ti hanno conciato?
 how 1SG.ETH.DAT 2SG.ACC have.3PL ill.treated.M.SG
 ‘How badly did they mess you up?’
 b. Come me La hanno conciata?
 how 1SG.ETH.DAT LEI.ACC have.3PL ill.treated.F.SG
 ‘How badly did they mess you (formal) up?’

ond person, as shown above in (5) and repeated in (21-a). This is in contrast with the combination of 1>3, which is acceptable for all speakers (21-b).

- (21) a. %Mi ti ha affidato.
1SG 2SG have.3SG entrusted.M.SG
%‘He entrusted you to me.’ / %‘He entrusted me to you.’
(based on Bianchi 2006:2027)
- b. Me la ha affidata.
1SG 3SG.F.ACC have.3SG entrusted.F.SG
‘He entrusted her to me.’

Strikingly, even among speakers who accept (21-a), substituting the second person accusative in (21-a) with an accusative LEI clitic makes the expression ungrammatical (22). There is no morphological reason for this combination to be ill-formed; the use of a third person accusative clitic in this position is grammatical, as seen in the preceding example (21-b). Manipulating the order or the allomorphic exponence of the clitics for (22) still results in ungrammaticality (**La me*, **Le mi*, **Le me*, etc.).

- (22) (Dottor Biagi,) *me La ha affidata.
 Doctor Biagi, 1SG.DAT LEI.ACC have.3SG entrusted.F.SG
 Doctor Biagi, he entrusted you to me.

We mostly set $1>2$ and $2>1$ environments with LEI to the side, returning to this issue later in Section 5.

4.2 LEI and the Fancy Constraint

We now extend our observations about person restrictions from PCC effects to the so-called Fancy Constraint. Two analytic causative constructions have been identified in the literature on Romance, often referred to as *faire par* and *faire infinitif* causatives; see Kayne 1975; Burzio 1986; Guasti 1996; Folli and Harley 2007; among many others. In Italian, the two are distinguished by how a causee is introduced: within a PP headed by *da* ‘from’ in the *faire par* construction but with a dative clitic or a PP headed by *a* ‘to’ in the *faire infinitif* construction (23).

- (23) a. Micol fa pettinare Giulia da Carlo.
 Micol make.3SG comb.INF Giulia by Carlo
 ‘Micol is making Carlo comb Giulia’s hair.’
 b. Micol fa pettinare Giulia a Carlo.
 Micol make.3SG comb.INF Giulia to Carlo
 ‘Micol is making Carlo comb Giulia’s hair.’
 (adapted, D’Alessandro and Pescarini 2016:275)

As noted by D’Alessandro and Pescarini (2016), a person-hierarchy effect can be found with the *faire infinitif* construction in Italian (but not for *faire par*)—an effect that Postal (1989) first discovered in French and termed the ‘Fancy Constraint’ (see also Bonet 1991; Sheehan 2020). In particular, there is a contrast between the acceptability of a third-person accusative clitic vs. a first- or second-person clitic. The contrast is illustrated in (24); notice that the effect obtains even though the causee argument is not a clitic in the example, a point which has been taken to indicate that the PCC is not strictly linked to clusters with clitics or weak pronouns (e.g. Sheehan 2020). (We note that our consultants tend to find the ‘baseline’-type case in (24) marked to begin with, though there is nevertheless a sharp person-based contrast.)

- (24) Micol {la /*ti} fa pettinare a Carlo.
 Micol 3SG.F.ACC 2SG.ACC make.3SG comb.INF to Carlo
 ‘Micol is making Carlo comb her/*your hair.’
 (adapted, D’Alessandro and Pescarini 2016:276)

As with the PCC effect found with ditransitives, we find that LEI patterns with the second person and not the third person in triggering a person-hierarchy effect with the *faire infinif*, as shown in (25). As with the PCC, the hierarchy effect vanishes when the argument LEI is expressed with a pronoun rather than a clitic (26).

- (25) *Signor Biagi, Micol La fa pettinare a Carlo.
 Signor Biagi Michol LEI.ACC make.3SG comb.INF to Carlo
 ‘Signor Biagi, Michol is making Carlo comb your hair.’

- (26) Micol fa pettinare te/Lei a Carlo.
 Micol make.3SG comb.INF 2SG.ACC.STRESSED/LEI.STRESSED to Carlo
 ‘Micol makes Carlo comb your/your(polite) hair.’

4.3 *Imposters and the PCC in Italian*

We can also contrast the PCC effect from LEI with what is observed with non-pronominal imposter and camouflage nominals, which, like third-person polite pronouns, are grammatically third-person for verbal agreement, but appear to represent their relationship with participant pronouns differently from polite pronouns; see Collins and Postal 2012 for one view of imposter structure, and Servidio 2014 on imposters specifically in Italian. We show that LEI behaves differently from non-pronominal imposters in Italian, both in terms of PCC effects and in terms of other agreement behavior. (See also Rezac 2011:297 for the observation that French imposters do not induce PCC effects.)¹⁰ This evidence suggests that the syntacticosemantic representation of LEI as (fundamentally) second person is not shared with imposters, giving rise to divergent behavior in PCC contexts.

We first show the absence of a PCC effect with the camouflage item *le Vostre Maestà* ‘the.F.PL 2PL.POSS majesties’ (with the possessive also agreeing in gender and number with the noun *Maestà*). In order to test this item within a PCC context, we employ a left-dislocated topic structure as in (27): the plural camouflage item *le Vostre Maestà* appears as a left-dislocated topic, which is indexed by a third-person accusative clitic agreeing with the feminine gender and plural number of the topic. (Because it is plural, it is clear that the clitic is not polite LEI, which would appear as a singular clitic and can only be used with singular addressees.) To make this a PCC context, a dative third-person clitic is also present, such that, if the camouflage item were treated as second-person, a PCC effect would be induced. In contrast, we find that the camouflage item does not give rise

¹⁰A related observation for Georgian comes from Harris (1981:Ch. 3), who points out that Georgian person-hierarchy effects in ditransitives vanish when a (reflexive-looking) ‘camouflage’ nominal is used in place of a participant pronoun, which agrees as if it is grammatically third person.

to a PCC effect, unlike LEI.

- (27) [Le Vostre Maestà]_i, glie_k le_i hanno già
 the.F.PL 2PL.POSS.F.PL majesty.PL 3SG.DAT 3PL.ACC have.3PL already
 presentate, al[l'ambasciatore]_k?
 introduced.F.PL to.the.ambassador.M.SG
 'Have they already introduced Your Majesties to the ambassador?'

We also find that camouflage items do not give rise to violations of the Fancy Constraint in Italian. In (28), the camouflage item *le Vostre Altezze* 'the.F.PL 2PL.POSS.F.PL highnesses' is again put into a left-dislocated topic structure, and is indexed by an accusative clitic in the *faire infinitif* construction. The expression is grammatical.

- (28) [Le Vostre Altezze]_i, il professore le_i
 the.F.PL 2PL.POSS.F.PL highness.PL the.M.SG. professor.M.SG 3ACC.F.PL
 farà esaminare all' assistente.
 make.FUT.3SG examine.INF to.the.SG assistant
 'The professor will make the assistant examine Your Highnesses.'

We can replicate the same pattern with the non-camouflage imposter *i signori* 'the gentlemen'. (Once again, because it is plural, it is clear that the clitic is not polite LEI.) In contrast to both second person and LEI, no person-hierarchy effect arises with the imposter nominal.

- (29) a. [I signori]_i, glie_k li_i hanno già presentati,
 the.M.PL gentlemen 3SG.DAT 3M.PL.ACC have.3PL already introduced.M.PL
 al[l'ambasciatrice]_k?
 to.the.ambassador
 'Have they already introduced the gentlemen (you) to the ambassador?'
 b. [I signori]_i, li_i faranno esaminare all' assistente.
 the.M.PL gentlemen 3M.PL.ACC make.3PL examine.INF to.the.assistant
 'They will make the assistant examine the gentlemen (you).'

That PCC and Fancy Constraint effects do not obtain with camouflage items or non-pronominal imposters, unlike with LEI, suggests that their relationship to second-person address is represented differently. While we take no firm stance on the representation of

camouflage or imposter DPs, we would like to highlight that they do indeed diverge in their behavior from *LEI* in that they are treated as if they are third-person in at least one other case where *LEI* is not. It has previously been noted in the literature on coordination resolution that resolved agreement is sensitive to interpreted features of the nominals, as evidenced especially by cases where formal features diverge from what is interpreted (e.g. Wechsler 2008; Adamson and Anagnostopoulou 2024, among others). We observe that this is true for coordination of *LEI* with a third-person nominal (30), which yields obligatory second-plural resolved agreement (as is also observed when the second-person informal pronoun is used instead of *LEI*). In contrast, the camouflage nominal and the imposter are compatible with third-person resolved agreement when coordinated with another third-person nominal, with the alternative second or first person agreement being ungrammatical or at least severely degraded (cf. Servidio 2014).

- (30) *Lei e l'ambasciatore {vi incontrerete /*si*
LEI.NOM and the.ambassador.M.SG 2PL.ACC meet.FUT.2.PL /REFL.3PL
incontreranno} domani.
meet.FUT.3PL tomorrow
'You (formal) and the ambassador will meet tomorrow.'
- (31) *La Vostra Maestà e l'ambasciatore di Svezia {si*
the.F.SG 2PL.POSS.F.PL majesty and the.ambassadorM.SG of Sweden 3.REFL
*incontreranno /*vi incontrerete} domani.*
meet.FUT.3PL /2.PL.ACC meet.FUT.2PL tomorrow
'Your majesty and the ambassador from Switzerland will meet tomorrow.'

The contrast between *LEI* and imposters for the PCC suggests that PCC effects do not arise pragmatically (in a broad sense), since both types of nominals are ultimately used for reference to addressees, yet not all addressee-referring expressions give rise to PCC effects. The contrast is instead in line with an account in which the syntacticosemantic representation of polite pronouns is necessarily second person in a way that imposters and camouflage nominals need not be.

5 LEI and the Theory of the PCC

We argue that the evidence from Italian polite LEI is incompatible with morphosyntactic analyses of the PCC, and instead favors a syntacticosemantic account. While space considerations preclude a more comprehensive evaluation of PCC accounts, we consider here a few representative examples from the recent literature.¹¹ In essence, our view is that for theories that derive PCC effects from the mechanics of Agree, because LEI behaves as a 3rd-person argument for purposes of agreement (as shown in Section 3), it is expected to obviate PCC effects, contrary to fact (as shown in Section 4).

For concreteness, we assume that polite pronouns have two sets of ϕ -features, which are both present in the narrow syntax, one of which is interpretable and the other of which is uninterpretable. On this type of dual-feature system and related systems, see Wurmbrand 2017; Smith 2015, 2017, 2021; Anagnostopoulou 2017a; Messick 2023a,b; Adamson and Anagnostopoulou 2024; Adamson 2024; among others; on polite pronouns in particular, Wurmbrand 2016 and relatedly Despić 2017; Puškar-Gallien 2019.¹² We assume LEI carries uninterpretable third-person, feminine, and singular features – consistent with its verbal agreement behavior – and interpretable second-person and singular features (with masculine and feminine genders both being viable depending on whether the addressee identifies as a man or as a woman) – consistent with the polite pronoun being confined to singular addressees. We postpone discussion of alternative analyses

¹¹We briefly note that the evidence from polite pronouns also poses a challenge to an analysis in which PCC effects are fundamentally morphological in character, as in Perlmutter 1971; Bonet 1991, 1994. As described in Section 3, LEI is formally identical to the third-person feminine singular pronoun across all of its realizations, including as an object clitic, and verbal agreement also treats it as third-person. If LEI is treated morphologically as though it is third person, any PCC-inducing morphological filter or constraint that restricts the distribution of second person should not be applicable to LEI, contrary to fact.

¹²This dual-system is also similar to that of Wechsler and Zlatić 2003; Hahm 2010; Wechsler and Hahm 2011, but with the division being between *interpretable* and *uninterpretable* values of ϕ -features, which are sent to LF and PF respectively. See Kaur to appear; Puškar-Gallien 2019 on agreement with honorific nominals for an alternative analytic possibility for having two distinct sets of features present in the syntax.

of polite pronouns to Section 7.¹³

We first critically evaluate several morphosyntactic accounts of the PCC in light of the polite pronoun evidence (5.1) before turning to a sketch of a syntacticosemantic account (5.2).

5.1 *Morphosyntactic Analyses of the PCC*

5.1.1 *Deal 2024*

As one representative example, consider Deal's (2024) Interaction/Satisfaction model, according to which a Probe may enter into an Agree relation with multiple Goals, interacting with every Goal in its domain until its 'satisfaction' conditions are met. Deal analyzes PCC effects in this model as resulting from i) probes having a satisfaction condition such as [PARTICIPANT], ii) an Agree relation being necessary for argument cliticization, and iii) the relevant probe interacting with direct objects before indirect objects.

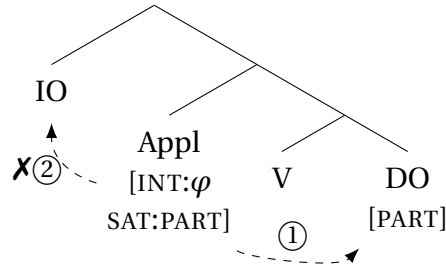
A derivation is schematized in the tree in (32): here, an Appl head is specified to interact with elements bearing ϕ features, and to probe until it finds a feature [PART]. In this example, the direct object bears [PART], which the Appl probe can agree with, thereby licensing argument cliticization of the direct object. However, because the probe identified [PART] on the direct object, its satisfaction condition has been met and it cannot

¹³That the polite pronoun's interpretable features are represented in narrow syntax is supported by the fact that some agreement targets, including predicative adjectives, agree with these interpreted values: adjectives (as well as subject-agreeing participles) reflect gender agreement with the conceptual gender of the addressee, rather than with the formal, feminine gender of LEI (see Wechsler and Hahm 2011 on this pattern cross-linguistically). This can be observed in the examples in (i): the predicative adjective agrees with the subject, yet despite the subject being (formally feminine) LEI, agreement is masculine when LEI refers to a man, but feminine when LEI refers to a woman. See Wurmbrand 2016 for one view of how agreement targets either uninterpretable or interpretable features of polite pronouns.

- (i) a. Dottor Biagi, Lei è così {buono/ #buona}.
Doctor Biagi LEI.NOM be.3SG so good.M.SG/ good.F.SG
'Doctor Biagi, you are so good.' (male addressee)
- b. Dottoressa Biagi, Lei è così {buona/ #buono}.
Doctor Biagi, LEI.NOM be.3SG so good.F.SG/ good.M.SG
'Doctor Biagi, you are so good.' (female addressee)

continue, thereby bleeding an Agree relation with the indirect object. This results in a (Strong) PCC effect, and the indirect object cannot be cliticized.

(32)



Consider now how LEI is expected to behave in this account. Recall that LEI is treated as 3rd-person for verbal agreement, including as an object clitic. Under this analysis, the probe should agree with a direct object LEI as if it is third-person and it should therefore fail to be satisfied, as it does not see a [PART] feature. It should therefore be able to agree with the indirect object (as in licit 1>3, 2>3, and 3>3 constructions) and no PCC effect should obtain, contrary to fact.

5.1.2 Coon and Keine 2021

As another recent representative, consider the ‘Feature Gluttony’ analysis from Coon and Keine 2021. In their analysis, PCC effects can arise when a probe enters into an Agree relation with multiple goals, as this can lead to crash-inducing conflicts for subsequent operations such as clitic movement and morphological realization. In their system, this situation arises for an articulated probe (i.e. one with multiple feature segments) if it first encounters an argument with fewer person features, followed by an argument with a richer set of person features. This is schematized in (33) for a 3>2 environment.

(33)

configurations, contrary to what we find with LEI.

5.1.3 *The Person Licensing Condition*

A distinct but related type of syntactic approach is pursued by Béjar and Rezac 2003; see also Béjar and Rezac 2009; Preminger 2009; Rezac 2011; Preminger 2014, and see Coon and Keine 2021 for criticism. According to such an account, PCC effects arise as a result of a Person Licensing Condition, which requires 1st/2nd-person features to be licensed via an Agree relation. In Béjar and Rezac's analysis, 1st/2nd-person direct objects violate the Person Licensing Condition when they occur with an indirect object, thereby yielding a PCC effect: a π -probe merged higher than both objects first sees the more local indirect object, and consequently cannot agree in person with the direct object, thereby failing to license it. (A second #-probe can Agree with the 1st/2nd-person direct object, but not in person, and therefore cannot license it.)

In Béjar and Rezac's system, the fact that LEI gives rise to PCC effects as a direct object in ditransitives suggests that LEI behaves as a participant for the purposes of the Person Licensing Condition. The problem, however, is that as we have seen, when appearing as a direct object without an indirect object, LEI is agreed with (and presumably thereby licensed) as though it is third-person. In order to account for the behavior of LEI with respect to both the PCC and ordinary verbal agreement, Béjar and Rezac would thus have to assume that Agree licenses the interpretable ϕ -features on LEI even though it copies its uninterpretable features. Notice, however, that this is effectively a syntacticosemantic account: the interpretable person features factor into the PCC while the features expressed in agreement do not.

A variant of this analysis comes from Rezac (2011), who formulates the Person Case Constraint as being about (case-)licensing a feature [+PERSON] on the (would-be) accusative object (p. 98). This type of analysis can accommodate hierarchy effects that extend to other non-participant nominals, including (third-person) reflexives in French,

which also induce a PCC-type effect in accusative object position (Rezac 2011:2). The idea is that [+PERSON] can be cross-linguistically variable to some degree in what types of nominals it is assigned to, such that reflexives in one language carry [+PERSON] and therefore induce PCC effects, while in another language, reflexives do not bear such features and therefore fail to give rise to PCC effects (e.g. p. 299).

The same logic for [+PERSON] is applied to third-person animate nominals. As observed by Ormazabal and Romero (2007) (also in their antecedent work), Spanish speakers of so-called *leísta* varieties distinguish between accusative clitics that are used for inanimates (*lo/la* – masculine singular and feminine singular, respectively) vs. those that are used for animates (*le*, syncretic with the dative); a hierarchy effect obtains only with the animate (34). This can be made sense of within Rezac’s system if third-person animates in Spanish (but not necessarily in other languages) are assigned the feature [+PERSON].

- (34) Te {lo /*le} di.
 2SG.DAT 3SG.ACC 3SG.ACC gave
 ‘I gave it/*him to you.’ Spanish *leísta* varieties (Ormazabal and Romero 2007:321)

In this type of analysis, the PCC effects observed with LEI could be attributed to the obligatory presence of [+PERSON] on polite pronouns. This is in fact what Rezac (2011:298-299) suggests for the third-person polite pronoun in Spanish USTED (including in *laísta* varieties), which is also briefly noted to give rise to PCC effects; see further discussion of Spanish in Section 6.

While this type of analysis can be made to work mechanically, because Rezac’s [+PERSON] feature is not tied explicitly to exponence or to interpretation, its presence on specific kinds of elements outside of participant pronouns is essentially arbitrary (Rezac 2011:299); as far as we can tell, [+PERSON] is stipulated in order to induce PCC effects. Absent other types of evidence for [+PERSON] within a language, it is difficult to see how

a learner would come to posit this feature, and if learners are in fact free to posit it or not, we may expect variation across speakers and across languages with third-person polite pronouns, with only some speakers opting to assign polite pronouns [+PERSON], contrary to what we find with LEI.

5.2 *Towards a Syntacticosemantic Account*

We suggest instead that a syntacticosemantic account of the PCC is on the right track. We view the fundamental property needed from such an account to be that these effects are tied to conflicts arising from interpretable person features rather than being inherently tied to the formal features that are overtly reflected in morphosyntactic agreement. While it is not our objective to argue for a particular implementation, we sketch how one recent account could contend with the PCC effects found with LEI.

We take a recent representative of the syntacticosemantic perspective to be the proposal by Pancheva and Zubizarreta (2018) (henceforth “P&Z”; see also Charnavel and Mateu 2015 and Stegovec 2020). P&Z attribute PCC effects to the encoding of point-of-view centers within a phase defined by some argument-introducing verbal head – for them, Appl. In brief, this head enters into an Agree relation, necessarily with *interpretable* person features, in order to establish its goal as a point-of-view center.

P&Z propose that PCC effects – including those referred to as ‘Strong’, ‘Weak’, ‘Strictly Descending’, etc. – are captured by the P(erson)-Constraint in (35). Their P-Constraint has several components, which are all subject to variation in parametric setting (see also Zubizarreta and Pancheva 2017).

- (35) *P-Constraint on phases α headed by an interpretable p(erson)-feature*
- a. The interpretable person feature is present on all heads of a certain functional category (default), unless restricted. (*Domain of application*)
 - b. There must be an n -valued D located at the edge of α that enters into an agreement relation with the n -valued interpretable person feature on the head of α . n is [+PROXIMATE] (default) or restricted to [+ PARTICIPANT] or

- [+AUTHOR]. (*P-Prominence*)
- c. There can be at most one DP in α eligible to agree with the interpretable p-feature on the head of α . (*P-Uniqueness*)
 - d. If there is more than one DP that can agree with the interpretable p- feature on the head of α , the DP marked [+AUTHOR] is the one that agrees. (*P-Primacy*) (P&Z:1300)

In this system, [+PROXIMATE] is a feature motivated by proximate/obviative distinctions made in some languages, and “proximate arguments are the ones suitable to be perspectival centers” (p. 1300). It falls in an implicational hierarchy with the person features [$\pm$ PARTICIPANT] and [$\pm$ AUTHOR], the plus values of which imply the presence of [+PROXIMATE]. (In other words, all first person and second person arguments are [+PROXIMATE], being suitable perspective-holders, but only some third-person arguments can be [+PROXIMATE], namely those that occur in the same domain as another third-person argument.)

To derive the Strong PCC, whereby 1st-and 2nd-person arguments are altogether banned from the direct object position in a double object construction, the setting in (a) is active, (b) has its default setting of [+PROXIMATE], and P-Uniqueness (c) is active ((d) is not). This rules in 3>3 configurations (as long as the IO counts as [+PROXIMATE]) but rules out 3>1 and 3>2 as follows: (b) requires that the IO be [+PROXIMATE], which is not possible for third-person unless it occurs with another third-person argument, and even if it did, P-Uniqueness (c) would be violated with 1st and 2nd direct objects, which are also inherently [+PROXIMATE]. For the Weak PCC, P-Uniqueness is not active, and thus 1>2 and 2>1 are possible for this grammar type, since there is no issue with having multiple arguments with [+PROXIMATE] in the same domain.

We now turn to PCC effects with LEI. The polite pronoun should bear [+PROXIMATE] by virtue of having interpretable 2nd person features (and as shown above in (15), LEI can indeed serve as an IO as expected). Considering the Strong PCC grammar, LEI in

DO position should be ungrammatical with a third-person IO because i) the IO cannot be [+PROXIMATE] in the context of (what is interpreted as) a non-third person argument, and ii) even if the IO could be [+PROXIMATE], this would lead to the co-occurrence of two [+PROXIMATE] arguments, thereby violating P-Uniqueness. For the Weak PCC grammar, (i) still holds, thereby also giving rise to a PCC effect for 3>LEI.¹⁴¹⁵

The P&Z account shares with morphosyntactic analyses the idea that Agree-based relations are complicit in the derivation of PCC effects. It is therefore able to capture syntactic aspects of the phenomenon, such as the fact that clitics are subject to PCC effects while stressed pronouns are not, under the widely held view that cliticization is a consequence of an agreement relation (see Pancheva and Zubizarreta 2018:1321-1324 for discussion, and Anagnostopoulou 2003; Béjar and Rezac 2003; Preminger 2019; Coon and Keine 2021; Deal 2024; among others).

A crucial difference between the type of syntacticosemantic analysis offered by P&Z and a morphosyntactic analysis, however, is that the agreement relation has an interpretive motivation (e.g. to identify point-of-view centers) and thus the person features that are considered are naturally the interpretable ones rather than the formal features that come to be expressed overtly in verbal agreement morphology.¹⁶ This is thus where an

¹⁴P&Z actually propose that P-Uniqueness is evaluated by having two person features on Appl: one that is interpretable and agrees with the IO and one that is uninterpretable and agrees with the the DO. Since this mechanism is meant to evaluate whether there are multiple potential point-of-view centers, we would assume that the unvalued probe is instead sensitive to the interpretable features of the DO (thereby inducing a PCC effect with LEI).

¹⁵Though P&Z do not discuss the Fancy Constraint, we suggest that their analysis can be extended to this type of person hierarchy effect. Recall from (24) that in the *faire infinitif*, a third-person causee could co-occur with an accusative clitic that is third-person but not second-person, and that LEI patterned with the second-person. In the detailed structural analysis of *faire infinitifs* in Folli and Harley 2007 (following insights also from antecedent literature), causative structure is introduced by a head v_{caus} (not present in the *faire par* construction, which also does not give rise to Fancy Constraint effects), and embeds a vP . It could be that the v_{caus} head is like Appl in P&Z's system, establishing another point-of-view domain. Alternatively, we may follow Sheehan (2020) and Deal (2024) in taking *faire infinitif* causatives to directly involve Appl itself rather than v_{caus} . We leave the question open.

¹⁶A different syntacticosemantic agreement relation is proposed to account for PCC effects by Stegovec (2020), who suggests that clitic pronouns enter the syntactic derivation as *minimal pronouns* (in Kratzer's 2009 sense), whose interpretable person features must either be valued via Agree with a verbal head or be

analysis of the PCC as a syntax/semantics interface issue can make sense of the polite pronoun data but where morphosyntactic accounts falter.

Before we conclude this section, we would like to return to the $1>2$ and $2>1$ patterns. Recall that $1>_{LEI}$ and $_{LEI}>1$ appear to be unacceptable, even for speakers who otherwise tolerate $1>2$ and/or $2>1$. While we are unsure of how this should be derived, we would like to suggest that it seems consistent with the perspective that the Strong PCC is the ‘default’ (including in the P&Z system), with the Weak PCC being a more marked variant. Ormazabal and Romero (2007:332-334) in fact suggest for Spanish that combinations of first and second pronouns appear to have a special status for speakers who tolerate these combinations, only being possible with particular verbs and patterning with non-argument clitics in various respects (see related discussion in Rezac 2011:150-151).

If this characterization is correct, this could mean within P&Z’s system that (35-c) is invariably active, with ‘Weak’ PCC speakers actually just being Strong PCC speakers who permit non-argument structure with some $1>2$ and $2>1$ configurations (which are therefore not subject to PCC effects). In the case of *LEI*, this exceptional structure appears not to be permitted; both the first person and *LEI* clitics are argument clitics and therefore induce PCC effects for Strong and Weak speakers alike.

valued as third-person by default (see especially Stegovec 2020:273–276).

According to this account, PCC effects arise because “in a structure with two *pro_{DF}* [...] only the higher *pro_{DF}* can receive a $[\pi]$ value from [the verbal head]. In doing so, it blocks $[\pi]$ -valuation of the lower *pro_{DF}*, which then gets a default value, that is 3P” (p. 274). In the case of DO polite pronouns, valuation by the verbal head of the IO’s person features blocks valuation of the DO’s person features, resulting in interpretable default third-person, inconsistent with the addressee interpretation. The account can therefore correctly capture the PCC behavior observed with polite pronouns.

While the implementation is different, Stegovec’s view is similar to that of P&Z in that for him, valued person features on the verbal head are present to encode “speech act participant perspective” (p. 276). Stegovec follows Charnavel and Mateu 2015 in suggesting an interpretability-based view is supported by PCC effects being ameliorated in non-*de-se* environments: Stegovec notes this for Slovenian, while Charnavel and Mateu note this for Spanish and French. See brief discussion of non-*de-se* environments in Italian in Section 7.

6 Other languages

On the assumption that PCC effects with ditransitives have the same grammatical provenance cross-linguistically, the general prediction of a syntacticosemantic account of the PCC is as in (36).

- (36) **PCC + Politeness Prediction:** If a language displays PCC effects in ditransitives for second-person arguments and has a third-person addressee-referring polite pronoun, this pronoun should also give rise to PCC effects.

This is a strong and falsifiable prediction, which can be tested across languages that both exhibit PCC effects with second person pronouns and have a third-person polite pronoun. However, the prediction warrants two important caveats. First, it is possible that a language has what might look like a third-person polite pronoun but is actually a non-pronominal (third-person) imposter. We observed for Italian in Section 4.3 that this distinction matters for the PCC, and expect this difference to carry over to other languages, as well.

Second, while we take PCC effects with ditransitives to share a common grammatical source across languages, we do not necessarily expect all other person-hierarchy effects to be attributable to the same source.¹⁷ It has in fact been reported that some person-hierarchy effects outside of the PCC are ameliorated by morphological syncretism between verbal inflectional forms, a phenomenon which has been argued to be more consistent with an approach that attributes these person-hierarchy effects to morphological conflicts that result in ineffability, as has been discussed for Icelandic dative-nominative constructions in particular (e.g. Schütze 2003; Sigurðsson and Holmberg 2008; Coon and Keine 2021; Hartmann and Heycock 2022).¹⁸ If the exponence-based view is on the right

¹⁷Alternatively, see Zubizarreta and Pancheva 2017 for the view that direct/inverse-type effects can be accounted for with the same type of P-Constraint applying to other verbal heads.

¹⁸P&Z suggest (fn. 17) that their analysis can be extended to dative-nominative constructions if their

track for such effects, then we would like to suggest that, if a language has a person-hierarchy effect that is ameliorated by syncretism, then no problem with exponence should arise with a third-person polite pronoun; this is in contrast to the expectation in (36).

In the rest of this section, we discuss two languages that have third-person polite forms and have been shown to exhibit person-hierarchy effects: Spanish (6.1) and German (6.2). We show first that Spanish conforms to the prediction in (36) for ditransitive PCC environments. For German, we first demonstrate that the known ditransitive PCC environment in German cannot be tested properly with a polite pronoun, for independent reasons. We then show, however, that a distinct person-hierarchy effect, which is known to be ameliorated by syncretism of verbal forms (Keine et al. 2019; Coon and Keine 2021), *does* treat the third-person polite pronoun as if it were third person, and thus no effect obtains with the polite pronoun, as is consistent with our expectation.

6.1 *The PCC and Spanish* USTED

Beyond Italian, it is well-known that PCC effects obtain across other Romance languages, as well (e.g. Bonet 1991), though the interaction of person-hierarchy effects and third-person polite forms are often not testable in other Romance languages because politeness forms are frequently accomplished via second-person plural marking rather than third person: this is true for French and Romanian (e.g. Wechsler and Hahm 2011). One notable exception is Spanish, which exhibits PCC effects (see Bonet 1991, 1994; Ormazabal and Romero 2007; among many others) and has the third-person polite form USTED.¹⁹

Like LEI, USTED behaves as a third-person argument despite referring to an addressee:

point-of-view principles can also apply to heads outside of Appl, such as to a specific flavor of *v*. Here we simply note that the syncretism data are not readily compatible with this extension, as far as we can tell.

¹⁹Another exception is Portuguese, which has a polite form *você* that takes third-person verbal agreement (see e.g. Wang 2023:1307).

in addition to finite verbal agreement with *USTED* (see e.g. Wang 2023:1306), third-person clitics are also employed for polite reference, including for the ACC clitic in *laísta* dialects (as shown in (37)-(38)).²⁰ (*USTED*, like *LEI*, also binds third-person reflexives.)

- (37) a. Yo te respeto.
 1 SG.NOM 2 SG.ACC respect.1 SG
 'I respect you.'
- b. Yo la respeto.
 1 SG.NOM 3 SG.ACC respect.1 SG
 'I respect her.'
- (38) Yo la respeto (a usted).
 1 SG.NOM USTED.ACC respect.1 SG (DOM USTED)
 'I respect you.'

Rezac (2011:298) observes that a PCC effect obtains in Spanish with *USTED*; see also Jambrović to appear. The phenomenon can be seen in (39): as is well-known (see Perlmutter 1970; Bonet 1991; Nevins 2007, among many others), the third-person dative clitic is realized as what is called 'spurious' *se*, a form syncretic with the reflexive-like clitic *se*. In (39), the accusative clitic *la* is grammatical in a 3>3 configuration if it refers to a third-person feminine singular referent, but it cannot be used as a polite *USTED* form in this expression. (The expression remains ungrammatical if *se* is changed to the dative clitic *le*.)

- (39) Se_i la presentaré (a los estudiantes_{*i*}).
 SE(=3 PL.DAT) {3 F.SG.ACC /*USTED.ACC} present.FUT.1 SG to the students
 'I will introduce her/*you (formal) to the students.' (Rezac 2011:298)

Three Spanish speakers we have consulted (Francesc Torres-Tamarit, p.c. and Cristina Real, p.c.) also report a contrast for the sentences in (40). In the well-formed expression in (40-a), *USTED* appears in the spurious *se* form of the dative with an accusative third-person clitic (*USTED*>3), which is expectedly grammatical. (In the parenthetical contin-

²⁰One difference between *LEI* and *USTED* is that the forms of the former are all identical to that of a different pronominal series (the feminine singular third-person forms), whereas the latter includes the citation form *usted*, which for many varieties is a dedicated politeness form not seen elsewhere among Spanish personal pronominal forms.

uation, the accusative third-person clitic is coreferent with the direct object of the preceding clause, and a null *USTED* subject triggers third-person agreement on the verb.) The infelicitous sentence in (40-b) is string-identical, though as reflected in the glossing, has an intended reading whereby *USTED* is the accusative clitic and the dative *se* is a third-person argument (hence 3>*USTED*). This reading is unavailable.

- (40) a. Yo se lo encomendé (con la
 1SG.NOM {3SG.DAT/**USTED*.DAT} 3M.SG.ACC entrust.PST.1SG with the
 esperanza de que lo cuidara bien).
 hope of that 3M.SG.ACC take.care.SBJV.IMPF.3SG well
 ‘I entrusted him to you (in the hope that you would take good care of him).’
 b. #Yo se lo encomendé (con la esperanza de que
 1SG.NOM 3SG.DAT *USTED*.ACC entrust.PST.1SG with the hope of that
 lo cuidara bien).
USTED.ACC take.care.SBJV.IMPF.3SG well
 ‘I entrusted you (formal) to him/her (in the hope that (s)he would take good
 care of you).’

Italian and Spanish thus exhibit the same pattern with respect to their polite pronominals, in that both give rise to PCC effects.²¹

6.2 *Person-hierarchy effects and German SIE*

We now turn to German, which shares with Italian both i) the use of third-person polite pronouns for addressees; and ii) the appearance of person-hierarchy effects, including the PCC. We first consider PCC environments, which appear in a small corner of the language (Anagnostopoulou 2008). Unfortunately, our prediction cannot be tested with polite pronouns because, as we show, the conditions necessary to observe PCC effects in the language cannot be satisfied with the pronouns in question. We then consider a second effect reported by Keine et al. 2019; Coon and Keine 2021, in which copular ‘assumed-identity’ contexts exhibit person-based restrictions. This person-hierarchy ef-

²¹We also note that the PCC effect with *USTED* may challenge Collins and Ordóñez’s (2021) contention that *USTED* is an imposter, if Spanish behaves like Italian in permitting imposters to appear in PCC environments felicitously (as discussed for Italian in Section 4.3). It is alternatively possible that Collins and Ordóñez’s characterization of *USTED* is only applicable to the form *usted* but not to the clitic forms.

fect is different from PCC effects in that there is an accompanying number-hierarchy effect, and even more strikingly, these effects are ameliorated by syncretism. We assume that amelioration by syncretism supports an exponence-based analysis of person-hierarchy effects, and our expectation is therefore that a third-person polite pronoun should not give rise to such effects. As we show, this is borne out.

German has a set of polite pronominal forms that uses the third-person plural series across cases (nominative, accusative, dative, and possessive: *Sie, Sie, Ihnen, Ihr*, respectively); we refer collectively to this set as SIE. As in Italian, polite subjects trigger agreement as if they were third person, and are ungrammatical with second-person agreement, as shown in (41). SIE also necessarily binds a third-person reflexive *sich* rather than employing the second-person singular form *dich*. (Unlike Italian *Lei*, German *Sie* can be used for both singular and plural addressees.)

- | | | | | |
|------|----|---|----|---|
| (41) | a. | <i>Sie</i> {sind/*bist} nett.
3PL.NOM be.3PL/be.2SG nice
‘They are nice.’ | b. | <i>Sie</i> {sind/*bist} nett.
SIE.NOM be.3PL/be.2SG nice
‘You (SG/PL formal) are nice.’ |
|------|----|---|----|---|

Because *Sie* refers to (an) addressee(s), the expectation under the current view is that any PCC effect in German that rules out combinations with a second person pronoun should also obtain with *Sie*. While the PCC had previously been thought not to be operative in German, Anagnostopoulou (2008) finds that it is, albeit in a small corner of the language. In particular, (weak) PCC effects only arise with pronominal clusters in the so-called Wackernagel position when the cluster appears before the subject. As shown in (42-a), it is possible to have a cluster of two weak pronouns precede a subject (in ACC > DAT order; on which see Müller 1999 and references therein). However, certain person combinations are ill-formed (at least for speakers Anagnostopoulou consulted), including when the direct object is first or second person and the indirect object is third person; this is shown for a second-person object in (42-b). Anagnostopoulou observes

that the effect is very restricted; for example, it vanishes when the subject appears before the pronominal cluster (Anagnostopoulou 2008:26).²²

- (42) a. dass es ihm der Fritz gegeben hat
 that 3SG.N.NOM 3SG.M.DAT the.NOM Fritz given has
 ‘that Fritz gave it to him’
 b. *weil dich ihm irgendwer vorgestellt hat
 because 2SG.ACC 3SG.M.DAT someone.NOM introduced has
 ‘because someone introduced you to him’ (Anagnostopoulou 2008:24-26)

The example in (42-a) shows that combinations of 3>3 are possible in this type of expression. Unfortunately, it seems not to be possible to have this combination if the direct object uses a 3PL pronoun *sie* (43) (and the same is true if *sie* picks out a third-person singular feminine referent).²³

- (43) dass {es / ??/*sie} ihm dieser Mann gegeben hat
 that 3N.SG.ACC / 3PL.ACC 3M.SG.DAT the.NOM man given has
 ‘that this man has given it/*them to him’ (e.g. the book, the books)

That the third-person use of *sie* is severely degraded in this construction means that we cannot properly test whether polite SIE obviates PCC effects: the relevant (plural) third person accusative pronoun cannot appear fully acceptably in this position in the first place. That being said, polite use of SIE is also bad in this position, consistent with our prediction, though confounded by this problem.

- (44) *dass Sie ihm dieser Mann vorgestellt hat.
 that SIE.ACC 3M.SG.DAT this man introduced has
 ‘that this man_i introduced you (polite) to him_j.’

A different person-hierarchy effect in German is observed by Keine et al. (2019) and

²²Judgments for such sentences seem unstable, though we were able to replicate Anagnostopoulou’s reported generalization more reliably when preceding context licensed stress appearing on a definite nominative subject.

²³We do not understand the source of this restriction. Plausibly, the issue is related either to prosody or to syncretism of *sie* across nominative and accusative cases, though the latter possibility is problematized by the fact that the neuter singular *es* can go in this position despite also being syncretic across these two cases.

is discussed further by Coon and Keine (2021), who find that both person and number hierarchies are implicated in copular ‘assumed-identity’ expressions (on which, see also Heycock 2012). In particular, these authors present experimental evidence indicating that German speakers permit 1/2 > 3 sentences like (45-a), but do not allow 3 > 1/2 (45-b). They also find a number hierarchy effect, whereby PL > SG is possible (46-a), but the reverse is not (46-b). (It is crucial that the copular sentences have the interpretation that DP1 takes on the role of DP2 and not the other way around.)

- (45) a. Du bist Martin.
 2SG.NOM be.2SG Martin
 ‘You are Martin.’
 b. *Martin ist du.
 Martin be.2SG 2SG.NOM
 ‘Martin is you.’ (C&K2021:685)
- (46) a. Die Kinder sind der Baum.
 the.PL child.PL be.3PL the.SG tree
 ‘The children are the tree.’
 b. *Maria ist die Bäume.
 Maria be.3SG the.PL tree.PL
 ‘Maria is the trees.’ (C&K2021:685)

While there is a clear resemblance to PCC environments, this context is nevertheless different in four respects: i) there is no obvious sense in which applicative structure is employed; ii) there is an accompanying number hierarchy effect; iii) the case of the two nominals is nominative (rather than e.g. DAT-ACC) for both; and iv) it is reported that syncretisms between the agreeing forms have an ameliorating effect on the hierarchy effects.²⁴ On (iv), Keine et al. (2019) report that judgments improve when the form of the copula is compatible with agreement with either nominal, and this is the case for 1SG and 3SG forms of the copula in past tense forms (47) and in the subjunctive; this is expected under an account that ties the effect (in part) to an issue of exponence.

- (47) Er {*ist /?war} ich.
 3SG.NOM be.3SG /be.PST.3SG/ 1SG 1SG.NOM
 ‘He is/was me.’ (Keine et al. 2019:4,29)

²⁴As far as we can tell, P&Z’s account does not predict this person hierarchy effect, though it does not rule it out, either, if non-PCC person hierarchy effects may also arise in other parts of the grammar.

Because of the syncretism facts in particular, our expectation for this type of person-hierarchy effect is that a third-person polite pronoun will behave like any third-person pronoun in not giving rise to the effect. This is indeed borne out.

First observe the person-based contrast when the subject (DP1) is a third-plural nominal (48): when the predicative nominal (DP2) is a third-person plural pronoun, the expression is grammatical, but if DP2 is a second-person plural pronoun, the expression is ungrammatical.²⁵

- (48) Die Zwillinge sind {(?)sie /*ihr}.
- the.NOM.PL twins be.3PL 3PL.NOM 2PL.NOM
- ‘The twins are them/*you.’

In Coon and Keine’s (2021) analysis, the ungrammaticality in data like (48) arises because a probe on T agrees with both DPs, leading to a ‘gluttonous’ configuration in which the person feature specifications between the two goals clash. As Coon and Keine clarify, this is itself not a problem; the issue is that the T probe cannot realize the clashing feature sets with a single vocabulary item, thereby yielding ineffability.

A prediction of any such exponence-based account is that no such complication should arise if DP2 is polite SIE rather than a second-person form. (For Coon and Keine’s analysis, the probe on T should find [PERS] and [PL] on both DPs, and should therefore be able to be realized with third-plural morphology.) This is borne out, as shown in (49).

- (49) Die Zwillinge sind Sie.
- the.NOM.PL twins be.INDC.3PL SIE.NOM
- ‘The twins are you (SG/PL).’ (also: ‘you are the twins’)

We have thus identified a person-hierarchy effect in German that conforms to the predictions of a morphosyntactic analysis rather than a syntacticosemantic one. Given

²⁵Some speakers we consulted report that *seid* ‘be.2SG’ is possible for them with the relevant interpretation when DP2 is the second-person plural *ihr*, though this is ungrammatical for other speakers we consulted. Experimental results from Keine et al. 2019 similarly indicate that speakers find DP2 agreement ungrammatical in contexts where person and number hierarchies are not respected.

the differences between PCC environments and the German assumed-identity context with respect to their behavior with polite pronouns, we have suggested that PCC environments have a syntacticosemantic source whereas other person-hierarchy effects may have a morphosyntactic source. This also converges with Drummond and O'Hagan's (2020) recent conclusion that person-hierarchy effects across constructions and languages might have heterogeneous sources (in their proposal, syntactic sources as opposed to morphological sources).²⁶

7 Concluding Remarks

We found that the Italian polite pronoun *Lei* does not conform to the predictions of a morphosyntactic account of PCC effects: despite *Lei*'s third-person verbal agreement behavior, it patterns with second person in giving rise to PCC effects. We suggested that these data are more compatible with a syntacticosemantic analysis of PCC effects such as that of Pancheva and Zubizarreta 2018. We emphasize here that this is not intended as an endorsement specifically of P&Z's account; see especially Deal 2024 for criticism.²⁷

²⁶We know of at least one other language in which the prediction in (36) might be testable. According to Wang (2023:1297), several languages make use of third-person in (certain types of) politeness contexts, including the Pama-Nyungan language Warlpiri (see discussion in Wang 2023:1300, citing Laughren 2001), and this language also has been reported to exhibit PCC effects (Haspelmath 2004:7, citing Hale 1973:334; see theoretical discussion in Stegovec 2015).

The only other relevant prior claim that we are aware of comes from Preminger (2014:124-125), who suggests that in the language K'ichee', a pronoun used for formal address behaves more like a third-person argument for the agreement purposes of the Agent Focus construction (citing a footnote from Stiebels 2006:526). However, no empirical support is provided for this, and moreover, this characterization is about the choice of agreement controller in the construction, rather than with person restrictions on the co-occurrence of arguments. Regardless, we assume that the Agent Focus construction should be subsumed under the same umbrella of person-hierarchy effects as assumed-identity contexts, since there is likely no applicative structure involved.

²⁷One empirical concern about P&Z's account is that their P-Prominence condition is meant to be parameterizable, such that the interpretable feature on the Appl head may be [+PARTICIPANT] rather than [+PROXIMATE], which they make use of in the derivation of so-called 'Super-Strong' PCC effects which ban combinations of 3>3 in some languages including Kambera. However, if we understand the system correctly, this part of P&Z's analysis seems to incorrectly predict that such languages do not tolerate third-

Rather, we submit that a syntactico-semantic based theory of the PCC is on the right track, with P&Z's point-of-view account being a recent representative example (see relatedly Charnavel and Mateu 2015 and Stegovec 2020).

While we evaluated morphosyntactic proposals of the PCC in Section 5 assuming a particular dual-feature analysis of polite pronouns, alternative analyses of polite pronouns can also be found in the literature; in 7.1, we show how these alternatives fare for LEI and for PCC effects. We conclude with a discussion of outstanding issues pertaining to the so-called Clitic Logophoric Restriction and to non-*de-se* environments (7.2).

7.1 *The representation of polite pronouns*

7.1.1 *Wang 2023*

Unlike our assumed dual-feature representation of polite pronouns, Wang's (2023) proposal for polite pronouns is semantic-pragmatic in character. Considering a large sample of languages, Wang shows that the feature values 'recruited' for polite pronouns across many languages are plural number, third person, and indefiniteness, which have independently been shown to be semantically unmarked values with the weakest presuppositions (see relatedly Sauerland 2008). Wang argues that polite pronouns use these unmarked values in morphosyntax, motivated by a pragmatic maxim referred to as the *Taboo of Directness*, according to which politeness contexts require the weakest presupposition (for some feature(s)). This account links politeness to avoidance of specific reference, and correctly captures the values of person, number, and definiteness that are coopted in politeness contexts across languages.

The application of Wang's account to LEI encounters (at least) two problems. First,

person IOs altogether, which the data they cite from Kambera already indicate is not true (P&Z2018:1321, ex. 36b) (this data point involves a lack of DO cliticization but is grammatical with a third-person dative clitic). Similar issues are applicable for the derivation of *me*-first PCC effects, which they derive via P-Prominence requiring a [+AUTHOR] feature. In general, the P&Z system seems to make incorrect predictions for when there is an IO clitic but no agreeing/cliticizing DO.

it does not correctly predict that the marked feminine gender is employed in Italian for LEI rather than the unmarked masculine: it is not plausible that the Taboo of Directness could dictate the use of a feminine form instead of a masculine one (on gender markedness in Italian, see e.g. Percus 2011), so gender features would minimally have to be morphosyntactically specified not to be interpreted. Second, because reference to the addressee is not grammatically encoded directly, but rather, is implied by the pragmatic system under this view, a morphosyntactic or a syntacticosemantic analysis of the PCC would predict that no PCC effects should obtain with third-person polite pronouns, contrary to fact. Alternatively, a semanticopragmatic account of PCC effects under this view would incorrectly predict that imposters *should* give rise to PCC effects, contrary to fact (as discussed in Section 4.3).

7.1.2 *Wechsler and Hahm 2011*

The proposal for polite pronouns from Wechsler and Hahm 2011 is framed within a dual-feature system known from the LFG literature (especially Wechsler and Zlatić 2003), with CONCORD and INDEX features, which are respectively “grammaticalizations of the form and the meaning of the [agreement] trigger” (p. 265), respectively. In their system, CONCORD features include lexically specific features such as declension and gender, whereas INDEX features are tied to properties of discourse reference, including person features. W&H’s analysis of polite pronouns focuses cross-linguistically on second-person plurals, which display a striking ‘mixed’ pattern across many languages (e.g. in French), whereby verbal agreement is necessarily plural – agreeing with the formal number of the pronoun – whereas adjectival agreement is singular if the addressee is singular. W&Z propose that this dichotomy arises as a result of i) a division between agreement targets that express CONCORD features or INDEX features, with the former agreeing in features such as gender, number, and case (e.g. adjectives) and the latter agreeing in features such as person, number, and gender (e.g. verbs); ii) specification of polite pronouns

only for INDEX features in these languages, and iii) allowance for ‘semantic agreement’ in cases of feature underspecification. Because verbal agreement requires INDEX features, it necessarily refers to the specified features of polite pronouns (e.g. plural for second-person plural polite forms).

It is not clear from W&H’s system how polite pronouns come to be interpreted as denoting addressees: INDEX features are typically associated with referential properties yet they are the grammatically specified features for polite pronouns – hence third-person plural pronouns will trigger third-person plural verb agreement (see Wurmbrand 2016:fn. 34 for a related criticism). More problematically for present purposes, third-person polite pronouns in the W&H system would bear third-person INDEX features, in which case they should behave like third-person arguments for person agreement. Since person is an INDEX feature in their system, an agreement-based account of the PCC would predict under this system that no effects should obtain with polite pronouns, contrary to fact.

7.1.3 Ackema and Neeleman 2018

Ackema and Neeleman (2018:42-50) propose to derive formal identity between polite pronouns and other pronouns within a language via impoverishment at PF or LF. In their system, polite pronouns necessarily bear a feature HON (honorific) along with second person features (for them, PROX and DIST) in the syntax, with these features being visible to syntactic processes. Subsequently, deletion triggered by the feature HON can occur either on the PF branch or the LF branch, giving rise to discrepancies between the realization of polite pronouns (and their agreement targets) at PF and the interpretation of these elements at LF. For example, Ackema and Neeleman suggest that second-person plural polite pronouns, such as those found in many languages (e.g. French), should be specified with a PL feature in the syntax, which is deleted in the context of HON at LF, resulting in number-neutrality at LF despite the plural form of the pronoun. Corre-

spondingly, for third-person politeness pronouns such as the one found in German, the addressee-specific person features (for them, PROX) are deleted at PF in the context of HON, yielding the less marked realization of the pronoun as third person.

This style of analysis could in principle be applied to LEI, in which case, syntax-specific analyses of the PCC could correctly generate the badness of LEI in PCC environments, as LEI would be represented with second-person features in the narrow syntax. As in German, PF impoverishment would apply to delete second person features yielding third-person forms. To derive its feminine form and agreement, LEI would need to have a feature FEM in the syntax and undergo impoverishment at LF, such that it was interpreted gender-neutrally.

As Ackema and Neeleman discuss, such an account predicts that, for syntactic purposes, the polite pronoun should behave as a second-person pronoun.²⁸ We would like to suggest that this is in fact not borne out for LEI. As noted above in Section 3, LEI as an object clitic triggers obligatory feminine agreement with a participle, in contrast to participant clitics including the second-singular *ti*, for which agreement is only optional. If we take the optionality of participial agreement with participant clitics to be attributable to the syntax (cf. Guasti and Rizzi 2002:191; Belletti 2017:499), then LEI appears to behave syntactically as third-person rather than second, contrary to expectation.

²⁸Ackema and Neeleman discuss this prediction for the German third-plural polite pronoun *SIE*, suggesting that two types of expressions distinguish second from third person, with the polite pronoun behaving in line with the former: i) adnominal pronoun constructions of the *you linguists* type – which are possible for second person but not for third (as in English, *you/*they linguists*), and ii) relative clauses headed by pronominals, which take resumptive subjects in German with second person but not with third. We first note that for both, the dual-feature analysis is compatible, so long as the interpretable features can factor into the syntactic selection (which is poorly understood for both phenomena). Empirically, regarding (i), these type of adnominal constructions are not possible with singular pronouns in Italian for either second or third person, and therefore this cannot be tested; regarding (ii), there is no known analogue in Italian, and we note that the judgments with second person are in fact more variable than characterized by Ackema and Neeleman for German; see especially the experimental evidence from Trutkowski and Weiß 2016.

7.2 *Remaining Issues*

One outstanding mystery internal to Italian, which we have heretofore not addressed, concerns what Pancheva and Zubizarreta (2018) refer to as the the Clitic Logophoric Restriction (CLR). As discussed by P&Z, following observations from Roca (1992) and Charnavel and Mateu (2015) (see relatedly Ormazabal and Romero 2007 and Bhatt and Šimík 2009), an accusative clitic referring to (but not necessarily c-commanded by) is ungrammatical in the context of a third-person dative clitic in Spanish and in French, but is reported to be grammatical when the dative is first or second person. While the CLR is discussed in the context of these other languages, we observe that the same generalization holds for at least some Italian speakers: in (50-a) a third-person dative with a third-person accusative attitude holder induces a CLR effect, while for some speakers (though not all we consulted), a second-person dative does not (50-a)-(50-b).

- (50) a. #Maria_i credeva che glie=_k la_i avremmo affidata
 Maria believed that 3SG.DAT 3F.SG.ACC have.CDL.1PL entrusted.F.SG
 (alla regina_k).
 (to.the queen)
 ‘Maria_i thought that we would entrust her_i to her_k (the queen_k).’
 b. ?/#Maria_i credeva che te la_i avremmo affidata.
 Maria believed that 2SG.DAT 3F.ACC have.CDL.1PL entrusted.F.SG
 ‘Maria_i thought that we would entrust her_i to you.’

P&Z suggest that the effect in (50-a), as well as its contrast with (50-b), can be captured under their account with the addition of a Point-of-View Principle (Pancheva and Zubizarreta 2018:1328), which requires that “within a logophoric domain marking point of view, if there are attitude holders among the event participants, one of them has to be the point-of-view center”.

According to P&Z, a dative clitic like that in (50-a) is marked as a point-of-view center because it enters into an Agree relation with Appl. The CLR effect is then induced because the accusative clitic refers to an attitude holder while the dative clitic does not,

yet the dative is the point-of-view center, thereby violating the Point-of-View Principle: the sole attitude holder in the domain is not a point-of-view center. In contrast, the idea is that examples like (50-b) have two attitude holders (see their discussion on pp. 1326-1327 on speech-act participants as attitude holders), and one of them, namely the dative argument, is indeed the point-of-view center.

Regardless of the precise details for why the CLR should hold, we may ask whether LEI patterns with third-person dative arguments in inducing the effect, or second-person dative arguments in not giving rise to the effect. Under the view that LEI is interpretively treated as a second-person argument, it should be eligible to be an attitude holder and therefore, for speakers who accept (50-b), it should be possible for LEI to appear as a dative alongside an accusative clitic attitude holder. However, this is not borne out; all speakers, including those who accept (50-b), reject (51).

- (51) #Dottor_iessa, Maria_i credeva che Glie= la_i avremmo
 Doctor.F Maria believed that DAT.LEI= FEM.ACC.3 have.CDL.1PL
 affidata.
 entrusted.FEM.SG
 ‘Maria_i thought that we would entrust her_i to you (formal).’

We are unsure of why (51) should pattern this way, and it is not expected under the P&Z-type account, though we acknowledge that their analysis of the CLR is tentative.

A related issue comes from non-*de-se* environments. Charnavel and Mateu (2015) suggest that their syntacticosemantic account of person-hierarchy effects found with ditransitives is supported by amelioration of PCC effects in non-*de-se* environments in both French and Spanish; amelioration is also observed for Slovenian by Stegovec (2020). This is illustrated in the French example in (52), which has a 3>1 combination that nevertheless does not induce (as strong of) a PCC effect.

- (52) ?J_i’ ai rêvé que j’ étais Marilyn Monroe_m, que j’ étais chez Kennedy_k
 I have dreamed that I was Marilyn Monroe that I was house Kennedy

et que je_m me_i lui_k présentais.
 and that I ACC.1SG DAT.3SG introduced
 “I_i dreamed that I was M. Monroe_m, that I was at Kennedy_k’s house and that I_m
 introduced me_i to him_k.” (Charnavel and Mateu 2015:693)

While we agree that the amelioration effect is in line with a syntacticosemantic account, we were unable to replicate the amelioration pattern in Italian, including with LEI, a topic that remains to be explored in future research.

Speaking more broadly, further research is needed in order to identify where in the grammar person-hierarchy effects can and do reside, with the issue not being fully settled in our view. The present article promotes the study of polite pronouns as a window onto such phenomena, with the hope that it leads to further inquiry that can continue to shed light on the PCC and other person-hierarchy effects.

References

- Ackema, Peter, and Ad Neeleman. 2018. *Features of person: From the inventory of persons to their morphological realization*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.7551/mitpress/11145.001.0001>.
- Adamson, Luke James. 2024. Split coordination with adjectives in Italian: An approach with multidominance and semantic agreement. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-024-09617-5>.
- Adamson, Luke James, and Elena Anagnostopoulou. 2024. Gender features and coordination resolution in Greek and other three-gendered languages. *Linguistic Inquiry* 1–76. URL https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00543.
- Adger, David, and Daniel Harbour. 2007. Syntax and syn-

- cretisms of the person case constraint. *Syntax* 10:2–37. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-9612.2007.00095.x>.
- Anagnostopoulou, Elena. 2003. *The syntax of ditransitives: Evidence from clitics*. Berlin: Walter de Gruyter.
- Anagnostopoulou, Elena. 2005. Strong and weak person restrictions: A feature checking analysis. In *Clitic and affix combinations: Theoretical perspectives*, ed. Lorie Heggie and Francisco Ordoñez, 199–235. Amsterdam: John Benjamins. URL <https://doi.org/10.1075/la.74.08ana>.
- Anagnostopoulou, Elena. 2008. Notes on the Person Case Constraint in Germanic (with special reference to German). In *Agreement restrictions*, ed. Roberta D'Alessandro, Susan Fischer, and Gunnar Hrafn Hrafnbjargarson, 15–48. Berlin/New York: Mouton de Gruyter. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110207835.15>.
- Anagnostopoulou, Elena. 2017a. Gender and defaults. In *A schript to fest Kyle Johnson*, ed. Nicholas LaCara, Keir Moulton, and Anne-Michelle Tessier, 23–31. Linguistics Open Access Publications. URL <https://doi.org/10.7275/R57D2S95>.
- Anagnostopoulou, Elena. 2017b. The Person Case Constraint. In *The Wiley Blackwell companion to syntax*, ed. Martin Everaert and Henk van Riemsdijk, 3001–3047. Oxford: Wiley-Blackwell, 2nd edition.
- Béjar, Susana, and Milan Rezac. 2003. Person licensing and the derivation of PCC effects. In *Romance linguistics: Theory and acquisition*, ed. Ana Teresa Perez-Leroux and Yves Roberge, 49–62. Amsterdam: John Benjamins. URL <https://doi.org/10.1075/cilt.244.07bej>.

- Béjar, Susana, and Milan Rezac. 2009. Cyclic Agree. *Linguistic Inquiry* 40:35–73. URL <https://doi.org/10.1162/ling.2009.40.1.35>.
- Belletti, Adriana. 2017. (Past) participle agreement. In *The Wiley Blackwell companion to syntax*, ed. Martin Everaert and Henk van Riemsdijk, 2972–3000. Oxford: Wiley-Blackwell, 2nd edition.
- Bhatt, Rajesh, and Radek Šimík. 2009. Variable binding and the Person-Case Constraint. Paper presented at 25th annual meeting of the Israel Association for Theoretical Linguistics (IATL), Ben Gurion University of the Negev.
- Bianchi, Valentina. 2006. On the syntax of personal arguments. *Lingua* 116:2023–2067. URL <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.lingua.2005.05.002>.
- Bonet, Eulàlia. 1991. Morphology after syntax: Pronominal clitics in Romance. Doctoral Dissertation, MIT, Cambridge, MA.
- Bonet, Eulàlia. 1994. The Person-Case Constraint: A morphological approach. In *The morphology-syntax connection*, ed. Heidi Harley and Colin Phillips, 33–52. Cambridge, MA: MIT Working Papers in Linguistics 22.
- Burzio, Luigi. 1986. *Italian syntax: A Government and Binding approach*. Reidel: Dordrecht.
- Charnavel, Isabelle, and Victoria Mateu. 2015. The clitic binding restriction revisited: Evidence for antilogophoricity. *The Linguistic Review* 32:671–701. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/tlr-2015-0007>.
- Collins, Chris, and Francisco Ordóñez. 2021. Spanish *usted* as an imposter. *Probus* 33:249–269. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/prbs-2021-0006>.

- Collins, Chris, and Paul Martin Postal. 2012. *Imposters: A study of pronominal agreement*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.7551/mitpress/9780262016889.001.0001>.
- Coon, Jessica, and Stefan Keine. 2021. Feature gluttony. *Linguistic Inquiry* 52:655–710. URL https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00386.
- D'Alessandro, Roberta. 2007. *Impersonal si constructions: Agreement and interpretation*. Berlin/New York: Mouton de Gruyter. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110207514>.
- Deal, Amy Rose. 2024. Interaction, satisfaction, and the PCC. *Linguistic Inquiry* 55:39–94. URL https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00455.
- Despić, Miloje. 2017. Investigations on mixed agreement: Polite plurals, hybrid nouns and coordinate structures. *Morphology* 27:253–310. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11525-017-9301-3>.
- Drummond, Emily, and Zachary O'Hagan. 2020. Morphological and syntactic person restrictions in Caquinte. In *Proceedings of NELS 50*, 197–206. Amherst, MA: University of Massachusetts, GLSA.
- D'Alessandro, Roberta, and Diego Pescarini. 2016. Agreement restrictions and agreement oddities. In *Manual of grammatical interfaces in Romance*, ed. Susann Fischer and Christoph Gabriel, 267–294. Berlin/New York: De Gruyter. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110311860-012>.
- Foley, Steven, and Maziar Toosarvandani. 2022. Extending the Person-Case Constraint to gender: Agreement, locality, and the syntax of pronouns. *Linguistic Inquiry* 53:1–40. URL https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00395.

- Folli, Raffaella, and Heidi Harley. 2007. Causation, obligation, and argument structure: On the nature of little v. *Linguistic Inquiry* 38:197–238. URL <https://doi.org/10.1162/ling.2007.38.2.197>.
- Guasti, Maria Teresa. 1996. Semantic restrictions in Romance causatives and the incorporation approach. *Linguistic Inquiry* 27:294–313.
- Guasti, Maria Teresa, and Luigi Rizzi. 2002. Agreement and tense as distinctive syntactic positions: Evidence from acquisition. In *Functional structure in DP and IP: The cartography of syntactic structures*, ed. Guglielmo Cinque, 167–194. New York: Oxford University Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780195148794.003.0006>.
- Hahm, Hyun-Jong. 2010. A cross-linguistic study of syntactic and semantic agreement: polite plural pronouns and other issues. Doctoral Dissertation, University of Texas, Austin.
- Hale, Ken. 1973. Person marking in Walbiri. In *Festschrift for Morris Halle*, ed. Stephen Anderson and Paul Kiparsky, 308–344. New York: Holt, Rinehart, and Winston.
- Harris, Alice. 1981. *Georgian syntax: A study in Relational Grammar*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Hartmann, Jutta M., and Caroline Heycock. 2022. Person effects in agreement with Icelandic low nominatives: An experimental investigation. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 41:1029–1090. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/s11049-022-09564-z>.
- Haspelmath, Martin. 2004. Explaining the ditransitive Person-Role Constraint: A usage-based approach. *Constructions* 2:1–71.
- Heycock, Caroline. 2012. Specification, equation, and agreement in copular sentences.

- Canadian Journal of Linguistics/Revue canadienne de linguistique* 57:209–240. URL <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0008413100004758>.
- Jambrović, Samuel. to appear. Pronominal structure and the third-person gap in Spanish. In *Proceedings of WCCFL 41*.
- Kaur, Gurmeet. to appear. Two ϕ -feature sets on honorific nouns. In *Proceedings of WCCFL 41*.
- Kayne, Richard. 1975. *French syntax*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.
- Kayne, Richard. 1989. Facets of Romance past participle agreement. In *Dialect variation and the theory of grammar*, ed. Paola Benincá, 85–104. Dordrecht: Foris. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1515/9783110869255-005>.
- Keine, Stefan, Michael Wagner, and Jessica Coon. 2019. Hierarchy effects in copula constructions. *Canadian Journal of Linguistics/Revue canadienne de linguistique* 64:617–648. URL <https://doi.org/10.1017/cnj.2019.28>.
- Kratzer, Angelika. 2009. Making a pronoun: Fake indexicals as windows into the properties of pronouns. *Linguistic Inquiry* 40:187–237. URL <https://doi.org/10.1162/ling.2009.40.2.187>.
- Laughren, Mary. 2001. What Warlpiri ‘avoidance’ registers do with grammar. In *Forty years on: Ken Hale and Australian languages*, ed. Jane Simpson, David Nash, Mary Laughren, Peter Austin, and Barry Alpher, 199–225. Canberra: Pacific Linguistics.
- Lyding, Verena, Egon Stemle, Claudia Borghetti, Marco Brunello, Sara Castagnoli, Felice Dell’Orletta, Henrik Dittmann, Alessandro Lenci, and Vito Pirrelli. 2014. The PAISÀ corpus of Italian web texts. In *Proceedings of the 9th Web as*

- Corpus Workshop (WaC-9)*. Association for Computational Linguistics. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.3115/v1/w14-0406>.
- Maiden, Martin, and Cecilia Robustelli. 2013. *A reference grammar of modern Italian*. London/New York: Routledge, 2nd edition. URL <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780203783504>.
- Messick, Troy. 2023a. 3/4 of a monster: On mixed shift agreement in Telugu. *Linguistic Inquiry* 1–15. URL https://doi.org/10.1162/ling_a_00512.
- Messick, Troy. 2023b. Hybrid agreement with English quantifier partitives. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 8. URL <https://doi.org/10.16995/glossa.10273>.
- Müller, Gereon. 1999. Optimality, markedness, and word order in German. *Linguistics* 37:777–818. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/ling.37.5.777>.
- Nevins, Andrew. 2007. The representation of third person and its consequences for person-case effects. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 25:273–313. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/s11049-006-9017-2>.
- Ormazabal, Javier, and Juan Romero. 2007. The Object Agreement Constraint. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 25:315–347. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-006-9010-9>.
- Pancheva, Roumyana, and Maria Luisa Zubizarreta. 2018. The Person Case Constraint: The syntactic encoding of perspective. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 36:1291–1337. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-017-9395-7>.
- Paparounas, Lefteris, and Martin Salzmann. 2023. First conjunct clitic doubling, the person case constraint, and first conjunct agreement: Insights

- from Modern Greek. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 8. URL <https://doi.org/10.16995/glossa.8417>.
- Percus, Orin. 2011. Gender features and interpretation: a case study. *Morphology* 21:167–196. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11525-010-9157-2>.
- Perlmutter, David. 1971. *Deep and surface structure constraints in syntax*. Holt, Rinehart and Winston.
- Perlmutter, David M. 1970. Surface structure constraints in syntax. *Linguistic Inquiry* 1:187–255.
- Pescarini, Diego. 2021. *Romance object clitics: Microvariation and linguistic change*. Oxford: Oxford University Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780198864387.001.0001>.
- Postal, Paul M. 1989. *Masked inversion in French*. Chicago: University of Chicago Press.
- Preminger, Omer. 2009. Failure to agree is not a failure: φ -agreement with post-verbal subjects in Hebrew. *Linguistic Variation Yearbook* 9:241–278. URL <https://doi.org/10.1075/livy.9.07pre>.
- Preminger, Omer. 2014. *Agreement and its failures*. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.7551/mitpress/9780262027403.001.0001>.
- Preminger, Omer. 2019. What the PCC tells us about “abstract” agreement, head movement, and locality. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 4. URL <https://doi.org/10.5334/gjgl.315>.
- Puškar-Gallien, Zorica. 2019. Resolving polite conflicts in predicate agreement. *Glossa: a journal of general linguistics* 4:1–25. URL <https://doi.org/10.5334/gjgl.587>.

- Rezac, Milan. 2011. *Phi-features and the modular architecture of language*. Dordrecht: Springer. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-90-481-9698-2>.
- Roca, Francesc. 1992. On the licensing of pronominal clitics: The properties of object clitics in Spanish and Catalan. Master's thesis, Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, Barcelona.
- Sauerland, Uli. 2008. The semantic markedness of ϕ features. In *Phi theory: Phi-features across modules and interfaces*, ed. David Adger, Daniel Harbour, and Susana Béjar, 57–82. Oxford: Oxford University Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780199213764.003.0003>.
- Schütze, Carson. 2003. Syncretism and double agreement with Icelandic nominative objects. In *Grammar in focus: Festschrift for Christer Platzack*, ed. Lars-Olof Delsing, Cecilia Falk, Gunlög Josefsson, and Halldór Ármann Sigurðsson, 295–303. Lund: Department of Scandinavian Languages, Lund University.
- Servidio, Emilio. 2014. Imposters and secondary sources in Italian. In *Cross-linguistic studies of imposters and pronominal agreement*, ed. Chris Collins. Oxford: Oxford University Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.1093/acprof:oso/9780199336852.003.0006>.
- Sheehan, Michelle. 2020. The Romance Person Case Constraint is not about clitic clusters. In *Dative structures in Romance and beyond*, ed. Anna Pineda and Jaume Mate, 143–171. Berlin: Language Science Press.
- Sigurðsson, Halldór Ármann, and Anders Holmberg. 2008. Icelandic dative intervention: Person and number are separate probes. In *Agreement restrictions*, ed. Roberta D'Alessandro, Susann Fischer, and Gunnar Hrafn Hrafnbjargarson, 251–280. Berlin: Mouton de Gruyter. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110207835.251>.

- Smith, Peter William. 2015. Feature mismatches: Consequences for syntax, morphology, and semantics. Doctoral Dissertation, University of Connecticut, Storrs.
- Smith, Peter William. 2017. The syntax of semantic agreement in English. *Journal of Linguistics* 53:823–863. URL <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0022226716000360>.
- Smith, Peter William. 2021. *Morphology–semantics mismatches and the nature of grammatical features*. Berlin: Mouton de Gruyter. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/9781501511127>.
- Stegovec, Adrian. 2015. It's not case, it's personal! Reassessing the PCC and clitic restrictions in O'odham and Warlpiri. In *Proceedings of the Poster Session of WCCFL 33, SFU Working Papers in Linguistics*, 131–140. Vancouver, BC: Simon Fraser University, SFU Linguistics Graduate Student Association.
- Stegovec, Adrian. 2020. Taking case out of the person-case constraint. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 38:261–311. URL <http://dx.doi.org/10.1007/s11049-019-09443-0>.
- Stiebels, Barbara. 2006. Agent focus in Mayan languages. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 24:501–570. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-005-0539-9>.
- Trutkowski, Ewa, and Helmut Weiß. 2016. When personal pronouns compete with relative pronouns. In *The impact of pronominal form on interpretation*, ed. Patrick Grosz and Pritty Patel-Grosz, 135–166. Berlin: De Gruyter Mouton. URL <https://doi.org/10.1515/9781614517016-006>.
- Wang, Ruonan. 2023. Honorifics without [HON]. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 41:1287–1347. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-022-09563-0>.

- Wechsler, Stephen. 2008. “Elsewhere” in gender resolution. In *The nature of the word: Essays in honor of Paul Kiparsky*, ed. Kristin Hanson and Sharon Inkelas, 567–586. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press. URL <https://doi.org/10.7551/mitpress/9780262083799.003.0024>.
- Wechsler, Stephen, and Hyun-Jong Hahm. 2011. Polite plurals and adjective agreement. *Morphology* 21:247–281. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11525-010-9168-z>.
- Wechsler, Stephen, and Larisa Zlatić. 2003. *The many faces of agreement*. Stanford, CA: Center for the Study of Language and Information.
- Wurmbrand, Susi. 2016. Formal and semantic agreement in syntax: A dual feature approach. In *Language use and linguistic structure: Proceedings of the Olomouc Linguistics Colloquium 2016*, ed. Joseph Emonds and Markéta Janebová, 19–36. Olomouc: Palacký University.
- Wurmbrand, Susi. 2017. Feature sharing or how I value my son. In *MIT Working Papers in Linguistics*, ed. Claire Halpert, Hadas Kotek, and Coppe van Urk, 173–182.
- Zubizarreta, Maria Luisa, and Roumyana Pancheva. 2017. A formal characterization of person-based alignment: The case of Paraguayan Guaraní. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory* 35:1161–1204. URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11049-016-9357-5>.